

Assignment 01

1. Farmers currently cannot sell any of their surplus farmed products. They often have to throw away their home grown crops since it is very hard for them to have access to the urban market. Food is being wasted on one side, while food insecurity exist on the other hand. The people who are in need of the surplus are in urban areas and farmers cannot break through that since they struggle with transportation. Hawkers cannot buy the products cheaper anywhere else except in bulks at supermarkets. This is a very big issue. The margins are very low when hawkers are trying to sell. They do not make a lot of profit and the farmers lose their surplus. This causes frustration, stress, doubt and many other negative emotions. Families going hungry despite food existing nearby.
2. Current process is not effective as both parties involved are not satisfied with the way things operate at the moment.. Its costly for one customer to move from urban areas to source in the rurals. Farmers do not achieve their goals s they do not sell the produced products effectively. Theres no efficiency in the system since its costs a lot to move from urban areas to source from very few farmers. Theres also no safety since the rural areas have unsafe roads and unreliable transportation. Also theres no safety since food is wasted instead of reaching people who need it, increasing food insecurity. There no utility since there is no mechanism for mechanism at all for matching supply with demand. Farmers always over produce and have to lose their produced products. No one is satisfied with how things are. Farmers need to sell their products and buyers are in need of the farmers produced products. Theres still a gap to be filled in order for both parties to be satisfied.
3. Stakeholders are farmers, hawkers, spaza shop owners, families, transport providers. The people who'd interact with the system would be mainly farmers and the people who want to buy from urban areas. Vulnerable households experiencing food insecurity. Transport providers. Also food relief organisations, Non-governmental organisations since they have an interest in reducing food waste.

4. Look for people who want crops from rural farmers. Find a way to link the two up so that when buyers buy, they buy in bulk minimizing the time spent on bad road infrastructure but also maximizing their profits. The proposed system would be able to bring the farmers and buyers together. Maybe a web-based agricultural marketplace that would also deal with logistics. Allow farmers to buy in bulk as all the farmers in the same neighbourhood would be working together to produce the amount of crops required by the buyers. Farmers will not have any surplus since there's going to be an up front desired amount of crops required by the buyers. Farmers will always be working to produce the design amount and therefore limit any losses involved in the process.
5. Feedback and Constraints. There needs to be an option that allows buyers to give comment on how the products were. I meant in terms of how good they were condition wise and also constrain because we know before farmers just produced without any number in mind. This is what caused the surplus and later losses. Constraints will help farmers to work towards a set target that will have people demanding it.

Question 2

- a. Finding new inroads to wicked problems.
- b. First I would start by defining the problem. Truly understanding what it is. In need order for us to truly understand it, we need to anchor ourselves in human needs, truths, and motivations. Meaning that calling together the people involved in the process both farmers and buyers from urban areas. Try to understand their complains if there are any. Try to see what they struggle with first and with that I believe we'd see loopholes in the system . The second step would be to re-engage with the problem from a different vantage point meaning that from step 1, we managed to see gaps that need to be filled. Now we try to solve the problem with the user in mind not just from our own view. The next step would be Catapulting insights into action meaning that we test certain hunches and hypotheses. We keep iterating if need be to get desired

outcome. Shaping a new era of inquiry meaning that we have totally changed how sellers and buyers interact with each other while lowering food insecurity.[168]